

The River Answers Back: A Missing Voice

河流的回应：缺席的声音

Theme: 环境、自然与可持续发展 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6, 127

English Story

The missing voice arrived at the end of a long afternoon, when **two** of the **seven** families on the list had not been visited, and **five** had. “I am **probably** one of the **eight** you decided to skip,” the woman said. “**Thirty** years I have watched this river, and I can **sing** you **its** **fifty** moods. **Recall** the last **chart**: **it** was made on the other side.”

She proposed that the **questionnaire** **contain** a page for what people remembered, not only for what they could count. **Forty** minutes later, **sixty** of her neighbours had signed **it**, and the **struggle** to **generate** **fifteen** more signatures turned into a small festival.

“You **accuse** us of being **tired**,” she said, “and you are **nineteen** years late with the **eighty** questions you want answered.” A **ninety**-year-old man with an **eleven**-metre rope said he could still **accomplish** more than the drone overhead. “Do not **yell** at the water,” he added. “Listen to **it**.”

The **chart** she drew had **eighteen** lines, and one of them was a **cattle** path. “A **globe** is not a **questionnaire**,” she said, “and a preacher is not a hydrologist.” The **surplus** of data in the station did not include the **dialect** of the river; the **refrain** of her account was the same every year.

It was difficult to **quantify** a scarcity of trust. A **smoky skyline**, a **separatist** slogan on a wall, and a **pushy** official with a clipboard: the group had to **innovate** or admit the **place** was not **reparable**. “**Take** the **activity** and the **place** together,” Lin wrote, “and you have the only **sustainable** measure we have.”

The **director** sent the **drive** with the recordings back to the lab and asked the team to **bring** the same energy to the field next week. **Its** **power** would come from the people who lived on the bank, the **different situation** of each family, and a **make** of evidence that **even** a **ten**-year-old could follow. The reader who was **seventy** and the child who was **eleven** sang the **refrain** together; the oldest was **ninety**, and he preached the same lesson without a pulpit. The **dialect** of the river was the only **chart** that mattered, and **ten** people had to **strive** against a **scarce** supply of patience. **As** a **force**, **it** did not **involve** the state. The **cattle**, the **globe**, and the **skyline** were all part of the same **questionnaire**.

中文翻译

那个缺席的声音在一个漫长的下午末尾到来，当时名单上七个家庭中有两个还没被访问，五个已经访问过。“我大概就是你们决定跳过的八个人之一，”那位女士说，“三十年我看着这条河，我能给你唱出它五十种情绪。回想上一张图表：它是在对岸做出来的。”

她提问卷里要有专门一页记录人们记得的东西，而不只是他们能数出来的东西。四十分钟后，她的六十位邻居签了名，而多争取十五个签名的奋斗变成了一场小小的节日。

“你们指责我们累了，”她说，“而你们迟了十九年才来问那八十个你们想得到答案的问题。”一位拿着十一米绳子的九十岁老人说，他仍然能做成比头顶那架无人机更多的事。“不要对水喊叫，”他补充说，“听它。”

她画的那张图表有十八条线，其中一条是牛道。“地球仪不是问卷，”她说，“传道人也并不是水文学家。”站里数据的剩余里，并不包含这条河的方言；她叙述的叠句每年都一样。

很难量化一种信任的稀缺。一片烟雾弥漫的天际线、墙上一条分离主义标语，以及一位拿着写字板咄咄逼人的官员：小组必须创新，否则就得承认这个地方不可修缮。“把活动和地方放在一起看，”林伟写道，“你就得到了我们唯一拥有的可持续的度量。”

主管把装着录音的驱动器寄回实验室，并要求团队下周把同样的精力带到现场。它的力量将来自住在岸边的人、每个家庭不同的处境，以及一种连十岁孩子都能跟上的取证方式。七十岁的那位读者和十一岁的那个孩子一起唱着那段叠句；最年长的那位九十岁，他没有讲坛，却宣讲着同一堂课。这条河的方言是唯一要紧的图表，而十个人必须在耐心稀缺的情况下努力。作为一种力量，它并不涉及国家。那些牛、那个地球仪，以及那条天际线，都属于同一份问卷。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
two tu: POS: num	num. 二, 二个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of one and one or a numeral representing this number; s. being one more...
five faiv POS: num	num. 五, 五个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of four and one; s. being one more than four
probably 'probəbli POS: adv	adv. 大概, 或许 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. with considerable certainty; without much doubt
contain kən'tein POS: vt	vt. 包含, 容纳, 控制; vi. 自制 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be divisible by; v. be capable of holding or containing
seven 'sevn POS: num	num. 七, 七个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of six and one; s. being one more than six
eight eit POS: num	num. 八, 八个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of seven and one; s. being one more than seven
thirty 'θə:ti POS: num	num. 三十, 三十个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the product of ten and three; s. being ten more than twenty
sing sin POS: vi	vi. 唱, 唱歌, 演唱, 鸣, 啼; vt. 唱, 歌颂; n. 嗖嗖声 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. deliver by singing; v. produce tones with the voice; v. to make melodious sounds
fifty 'fifti POS: num	num. 五十, 五十个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the product of ten and five; s. being ten more than forty
recall ri'kɔ:l POS: n	n. 回忆, 召回, 撤消; vt. 回想, 回忆, 召回, 撤消, 使恢复; [计] 检索 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a request by the manufacturer of a defective product to return the product (as for replacement or repair); ...
propose prə'pəuz POS: vt	vt. 计划, 打算, 建议, 提议, 求(婚); vi. 打算, 求婚 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make a proposal, declare a plan for something; v. ask (someone) to marry you
forty 'fɔ:ti POS: num	num. 四十, 四十个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the product of ten and four; s. being ten more than thirty
sixty 'siksiti POS: num	num. 六十, 六十个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the product of ten and six; s. being ten more than fifty
struggle 'strʌgl POS: n	n. 斗争, 努力, 奋斗; vi. 努力, 奋斗, 挣扎 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an energetic attempt to achieve something; n. strenuous effort; v. to exert strenuous effort against opposit...
generate 'dʒenereit POS: vt	vt. 产生, 发生, 导致; [电] 产生 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. bring into existence; v. produce (energy)
fifteen 'fifti:n POS: num	num. 十五, 十五个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of fourteen and one; s. being one more than fourteen
accuse ə'kju:z POS: vt	vt. 指责, 控告, 归咎于; vi. 指责, 控告 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. bring an accusation against; level a charge against
nineteen .nain'ti:n POS: num	num. 十九, 十九个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of eighteen and one; s. being one more than eighteen
eighty 'eiti POS: num	num. 八十, 八十个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the product of ten and eight; s. being ten more than seventy
ninety 'nainti POS: num	num. 九十, 九十个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the product of ten and nine; s. being ten more than eighty
tired taied POS: a	a. 疲累的, 疲惫的, 厌倦的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. depleted of strength or energy
seventy 'sevnti POS: num	num. 七十, 七十个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the product of ten and seven; s. being ten more than sixty
eleven i'levn POS: num	num. 十一, 十一个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of ten and one; s. being one more than ten
accomplish ə'kʌmplɪʃ POS: vt	vt. 完成, 达到, 实现, 使完美 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v put in effect; v to gain with effort

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
yell jel POS: vi	vi. 叫喊, 大叫, (齐声)呐喊欢呼; vt. 喊叫着说; n. 叫声, 喊声, 呐喊 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. utter or declare in a very loud voice
eighteen 'ei'ti:n POS: num	num. 十八, 十八个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of seventeen and one; s. being one more than seventeen
chart tʃɑ:t POS: n	n. 图表, 海图; vt. 制成图表; [计] 图表 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a visual display of information; n. a map designed to assist navigation by air or sea; v. make a chart of; v. ...
cattle kætl POS: n	n. 牛, 家畜; [法] 家畜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. domesticated bovine animals as a group regardless of sex or age
questionnaire kwɛstʃə'neə POS: n	n. 调查表, 问卷; [经] 调查表 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a form containing a set of questions; submitted to people to gain statistical information
globe gləʊb POS: n	n. 球, 球状物, 地球仪, 天体; v. (使)成球状 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sphere on which a map (especially of the earth) is represented
preach pri:tʃ POS: v	v. 传道, 讲道, 说教, 宣讲, 鼓吹; n. 说教, 布道 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. deliver a sermon; v. speak, plead, or argue in favor of
surplus 'sɜ:ples POS: n	n. 剩余, 过剩, 盈余; a. 过剩的, 剩余的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a quantity much larger than is needed; s more than is needed, desired, or required
sustainable sə'steɪnəbl POS: a	a. 足可支撑的, 养得起的, 可以忍受的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. capable of being sustained
strive straɪv POS: vi	vi. 努力, 奋斗, 斗争 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. to exert much effort or energy
scarce ska:s POS: a	a. 难得的, 稀罕的, 缺乏的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. deficient in quantity or number compared with the demand
dialect 'daɪəlekt POS: n	n. 方言, 同源语 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the usage or vocabulary that is characteristic of a specific group of people
refrain rɪ'freɪn POS: n	n. 重复的话, 叠句, 副歌; vi. 节制, 避免, 克制 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the part of a song where a soloist is joined by a group of singers; v. resist doing something
quantify 'kwɒntɪfaɪ POS: vt	vt. 定量, 用数量表示, 测量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. use as a quantifier; v. express as a number or measure or quantity
skyline 'skɑɪlaɪn POS: n	n. 天涯, 地平线, 空中轮廓线 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the outline of objects seen against the sky
smoky 'sməʊki POS: a	a. 冒烟的, 满是烟的, 熏脏的, 烟灰色的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. marked by or emitting or filled with smoke; s. tasting of smoke
separatist 'sepə'reɪtɪst POS: n	n. 分离主义者, 独立派 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an advocate of secession or separation from a larger group (such as an established church or a national un...
pushy 'puʃɪ POS: a	a. 粗鲁的, 固执己见的, 好胜而爱出风头的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s marked by aggressive ambition and energy and initiative
innovate 'ɪnəuveɪt POS: vi	vi. 改革, 创新 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v bring something new to an environment
reparable 'repərəbl POS: a	a. 可修缮的, 可赔偿的, 可补偿的; [法] 可修补的, 可补救的, 可纠正的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. capable of being repaired or rectified